

YEAR 9 (AFTER PREP) · THEME 8 · LIFE IN THE UNIVERSE & THE FUTURE

Reading

B2.1

The Hunt for a Second Earth · Life in 2126: Three Predictions

Hazırlık Sonrası 9. Sınıf

Name – Surname

Class

No

Date

Aim Understand the main idea and details, make inferences and connect the text to your own life.

1 Before you read

Make predictions before you read.

1. Look at the title. What do you think 'a second Earth' means?
2. What do you already know about how scientists search for planets outside our solar system?

The Hunt for a Second Earth

- 1 For centuries, humans have looked up at the night sky and wondered whether we are alone in the universe. Today, that question is closer to being answered than ever before. Using powerful space telescopes, astronomers have identified thousands of exoplanets — planets that orbit stars outside our solar system — and a growing number of them lie in what scientists call the 'habitable zone', the narrow distance from a star where temperatures allow liquid water to exist.
- 2 Finding an exoplanet is only the first step. To know whether a planet could actually support life, researchers study its atmosphere, its size, and the type of star it orbits. If a planet is too close to its star, it will be far too hot; if it is too far away, any water on its surface will freeze. Even a planet in the habitable zone might lack a protective atmosphere, leaving it exposed to deadly radiation. Because of these strict conditions, scientists estimate that only a small fraction of the exoplanets discovered so far could realistically host life.
- 3 Even so, the search continues, and new missions are launched almost every year. Some researchers believe that if we keep improving our telescopes and analysis methods, we will find strong evidence of a genuinely habitable world within the next few decades. Others are more cautious, arguing that space is so vast that finding the right planet — let alone actual life on it — could still take much longer. Either way, the hunt for a second Earth has changed the way many people think about humanity's place in the universe.

265 words

2 While you read

5 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

1. What is the main idea of the text?
 - a Scientists have already found a second Earth.
 - b Astronomers are searching for exoplanets that could support life, but the conditions are very strict.
 - c Space telescopes are too weak to find any exoplanets.
 2. The 'habitable zone' is the distance from a star where _____ can exist.
 3. According to the text, a planet too close to its star will be:
 - a too cold
 - b too hot
 - c too small
 4. All exoplanets found in the habitable zone are known to support life. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
-
5. A planet without a protective atmosphere is exposed to deadly _____.

3 After you read*Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.*

1. Do you think humanity will find clear evidence of a habitable exoplanet in your lifetime? Why or why not?

2. Write one sentence using the first conditional about what might happen if scientists find a truly habitable planet.

1 Before you read*Make predictions before you read.*

1. What do you imagine daily life will be like in 100 years?

2. Which area do you think will change the most: energy, technology, or space exploration?

Life in 2126: Three Predictions

- 1 What will daily life look like a century from now? No one can predict the future with certainty, but many scientists, engineers and futurists agree on a few likely directions, based on trends that are already visible today.
- 2 The first prediction concerns energy and the environment. If humanity continues to rely on fossil fuels, the climate crisis will almost certainly get worse, with more extreme weather and rising sea

levels. Many experts believe, however, that renewable energy will become the main power source worldwide well before 2126, driven by both necessity and rapidly falling costs. Cities may be redesigned to be almost completely self-sufficient, generating their own energy and recycling nearly all their waste.

- 3 The second prediction involves artificial intelligence and automation. Machines already perform many tasks once done only by humans, from analysing medical scans to writing simple reports. If this trend continues, entire industries could look completely different, and people may spend far more time on creative, social or scientific work rather than routine tasks. Finally, many researchers expect real progress in space technology: permanent research bases on the Moon, regular cargo flights to Mars, and perhaps even the first small human settlements beyond Earth. Whether these predictions come true exactly as described, one thing seems certain — the next century will bring changes as dramatic as anything in the last hundred years.

225 words

2 While you read

5 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

- What is the text mainly about?
☐ a A history of space exploration
☐ b Predictions about energy, technology and space in the next century
☐ c A list of countries with the best universities
- Many experts believe _____ will become the main power source worldwide before 2126.
- According to the text, artificial intelligence has had no effect on jobs so far. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
- What does the text suggest about future cities?
☐ a They may become almost completely self-sufficient. ☐ b They will stop using any energy at all.
☐ c They will be abandoned in favour of space colonies.
- Researchers expect permanent research bases on the _____ and regular cargo flights to Mars.

3 After you read

Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.

- Which of the three predictions in the text do you find most exciting or most worrying? Why?

- Write one sentence with 'I wish' about something you would like to be different in today's world.

